

The Mission of John the Baptist

Isaiah 40:1-5; Mark 1:1-8; Luke 3:1-20; John 1:19-28

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¹ In those days John the Baptist came, preaching in the wilderness of Judea

² and saying, “Repent, for the kingdom of heaven is near.” ³ This is he who was spoken of through the prophet Isaiah:

“A voice of one calling in the wilderness,

‘Prepare the way for the Lord,
make straight paths for Him.’”^a

⁴ John wore a garment of camel’s hair, with a leather belt around his waist. His food was locusts and wild honey. ⁵ People went out to him from Jerusalem and all Judea and the whole region around the Jordan. ⁶ Confessing their sins, they were baptized by him in the Jordan River.

⁷ But when John saw many of the Pharisees and Sadducees coming to his place of baptism, he said to them, “You brood of vipers, who warned you to flee from the coming wrath? ⁸ Produce fruit, then, in keeping with repentance. ⁹ And do not presume to say to yourselves, ‘We have Abraham as our father.’ For I tell you that out of these stones God can raise up children for Abraham. ¹⁰ The axe lies ready at the root of the trees, and every tree that does not produce good fruit will be cut down and thrown into the fire.

¹¹ I baptize you with water^b for repentance, but after me will come One more powerful than I, whose sandals I am not worthy to carry. He will baptize you with the Holy Spirit and with fire.^c ¹² His winnowing fork is in His hand to clear His threshing floor and to gather His wheat into the barn; but He will burn up the chaff with unquenchable fire.”

The Baptism of Jesus

Mark 1:9-11; Luke 3:21-22; John 1:29-34

¹³ At that time Jesus came from Galilee to the Jordan to be baptized by John. ¹⁴ But John tried to prevent Him, saying, “I need to be baptized by You, and do You come to me?”

¹⁵ “Let it be so now,” Jesus replied. “It is fitting for us to fulfill all righteousness in this way.” Then John permitted Him.

¹⁶ As soon as Jesus was baptized, He went up out of the water. Suddenly the heavens were opened,^d and He saw^e the Spirit of God descending like

^a Isaiah 40:3 (see also LXX) ^b Or in water ^c Or in the Holy Spirit and in fire ^d NA, BYZ, and TR the heavens were opened to Him ^e Or and he saw; see John 1:32-33|JHN 1:32-33.

a dove and resting on Him. ¹⁷ And a voice from heaven said, “This is My beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased!”

The Temptation of Jesus

Mark 1:12-13; Luke 4:1-13

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¹ Then Jesus was led by the Spirit into the wilderness to be tempted by the devil.

² After fasting forty days and forty nights, He was hungry.

³ The tempter came to Him and said, “If You are the Son of God, tell these stones to become bread.”

⁴ But Jesus answered, “It is written:

‘Man shall not live on bread alone,

but on every word that comes from the mouth of God.’^a”

⁵ Then the devil took Him to the holy city and set Him on the pinnacle of the temple. ⁶ “If You are the Son of God,” he said, “throw Yourself down. For it is written:

‘He will command His angels concerning You,
and they will lift You up in their hands,
so that You will not strike Your foot
against a stone.’^b”

⁷ Jesus replied, “It is also written: ‘Do not put the Lord your God to the test.’^c”

⁸ Again, the devil took Him to a very high mountain and showed Him all the kingdoms of the world and their glory. ⁹ “All this I will give You,” he said, “if You will fall down and worship me.”

¹⁰ “Away from Me, Satan!” Jesus told him. “For it is written: ‘Worship the Lord your God and serve Him only.’^d”

¹¹ Then the devil left Him, and angels came and ministered to Him.

Jesus Begins His Ministry

Isaiah 9:1-7; Mark 1:14-15; Luke 4:14-15

¹² When Jesus heard that John had been imprisoned, He withdrew to Galilee. ¹³ Leaving Nazareth, He went and lived in Capernaum, which is by the sea in the region of Zebulun and Naphtali, ¹⁴ to fulfill what was spoken through the prophet Isaiah:

¹⁵ “Land of Zebulun
and land of Naphtali,

^a Deuteronomy 8:3 ^b Psalm 91:11-12 ^c Deuteronomy 6:16 ^d Deuteronomy 6:13

of Man must be lifted up, ¹⁵ that everyone who believes in Him may have eternal life.^a

¹⁶ For God so loved the world that He gave His one and only^b Son, that everyone who believes in Him shall not perish but have eternal life. ¹⁷ For God did not send His Son into the world to condemn the world, but to save the world through Him. ¹⁸ Whoever believes in Him is not condemned, but whoever does not believe has already been condemned, because he has not believed in the name of God's one and only Son.

¹⁹ And this is the verdict: The Light has come into the world, but men loved the darkness rather than the Light because their deeds were evil. ²⁰ Everyone who does evil hates the Light, and does not come into the Light for fear that his deeds will be exposed. ²¹ But whoever practices the truth comes into the Light, so that it may be seen clearly that what he has done has been accomplished in God.”^c

John's Testimony about Jesus

²² After this, Jesus and His disciples went into the Judean countryside, where He spent some time with them and baptized.

²³ Now John was also baptizing at Aenon near Salim, because the water was plentiful there, and people kept coming to be baptized. ²⁴ (For John had not yet been thrown into prison.)

²⁵ Then a dispute arose between John's disciples and a certain Jew^d over the issue of ceremonial washing. ²⁶ So John's disciples came to him and said, “Look, Rabbi, the One who was with you beyond the Jordan, the One you testified about — He is baptizing, and everyone is going to Him.”

²⁷ John replied, “A man can receive only what is given him from heaven.

²⁸ You yourselves can testify that I said, ‘I am not the Christ, but am sent ahead of Him.’ ²⁹ The bride belongs to the bridegroom. The friend of the bridegroom stands and listens for him, and is overjoyed to hear the bridegroom's voice. That joy is mine, and it is now complete. ³⁰ He must increase; I must decrease.

³¹ The One who comes from above is above all. The one who is from the earth belongs to the earth and speaks as one from the earth. The One who comes from heaven is above all.^e ³² He testifies to what He has seen and heard, yet no one accepts His testimony. ³³ Whoever accepts His testimony has certified that God is truthful. ³⁴ For the One whom God has sent speaks the words of God, for God gives the Spirit without limit.

^a Or *everyone who believes may have eternal life in Him.* ^b Or *only begotten or unique; also in verse 18* ^c Some translators close this quotation after verse 15. ^d TR *and the Jews* ^e Tischendorf *The One comes from heaven.*

Jesus Predicts Peter's Denial

Matthew 26:31–35; Mark 14:27–31; Luke 22:31–38

36 “Lord, where are You going?” Simon Peter asked.

Jesus answered, “Where I am going, you cannot follow Me now, but you will follow later.”

37 “Lord,” said Peter, “why can’t I follow You now? I will lay down my life for You.”

38 “Will you lay down your life for Me?” Jesus replied. “Truly, truly, I tell you, before the rooster crows, you will deny Me three times.”[]]

In My Father's House Are Many Rooms



1 “Do not let your hearts be troubled. You believe in God;^a believe in Me as well.

2 In My Father's house are many rooms. If it were not so, would I have told you that I am going there to prepare a place for you?^b **3** And if I go and prepare a place for you, I will come back and welcome you into My presence, so that you also may be where I am. **4** You know the way to the place where I am going.”^c

The Way, the Truth, and the Life

5 “Lord,” said Thomas, “we do not know where You are going, so how can we know the way?”

6 Jesus answered, “I am the way and the truth and the life. No one comes to the Father except through Me. **7** If you had known Me, you would know My Father as well. From now on you do know Him and have seen Him.”

8 Philip said to Him, “Lord, show us the Father, and that will be enough for us.”

9 Jesus replied, “Philip, I have been with you all this time, and still you do not know Me? Anyone who has seen Me has seen the Father. How can you say, ‘Show us the Father’? **10** Do you not believe that I am in the Father and the Father is in Me? The words I say to you, I do not speak on My own. Instead, it is the Father dwelling in Me, performing His works. **11** Believe Me that I am in the Father and the Father is in Me — or at least believe on account of the works themselves.

12 Truly, truly, I tell you, whoever believes in Me will also do the works that I am doing. He will do even greater things than these, because I am going to the Father. **13** And I will do whatever you ask in My name, so that

^a Or Believe in God ^b Or If it were not so, I would have told you. I am going there to prepare a place for you. ^c BYZ and TR And where I go you know, and the way you know.